

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Noah's Ark - The Big Boat

Merkeb NoH - Abi Jelba

A Bilingual Bible Story

klte-quanqua nay metsHaf qddus zanta

Book 4 of 20

Ages 3-10

For every child who loves animals and trusts God's promises

nkulu qolA nEnsisat zfeter n ntsmAt Amlak zmAmen

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[PICTURE: A warm watercolor children's Bible illustration of a kind old man named Noah with East African/Eritrean features — warm brown skin, white curly hair and beard — standing in a beautiful garden with his family. His wife stands beside him smiling. Three grown sons and their wives are nearby. Animals roam freely — birds, sheep, a dog. Green trees and flowers surround them. Golden sunlight shows a peaceful, good life.]

ENGLISH:

A long, long time ago, there lived a good man named Noah. Noah loved God with all his heart. He had a kind wife, three sons named Shem, Ham, and Japheth, and their wives. Noah's family was special because they obeyed God when no one else did.

TIGRINYA:

Ab qedem qedem, Hade TsbuQ sebAy NoH ztstsmA neyru. NoH nAmlak bmluE Ibu yfetwu neyru. Hyanet Bealti, sleste Awlad — Sem, Ham, n Yafet — n Analstu neyrwu. Sdra bet NoH bflay neyre kemey Kalot keAyteAazzu Amlak yteAazezu neyrom.

(Pronunciation: NoH = Noah, TsbuQ = good, yteAazezu = they obeyed)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration showing a contrasting dark scene of the world around Noah. People are being mean to each other — fighting, stealing, and ignoring God. Dark stormy colors — grays and purples — fill the background. Broken things litter the ground. People look angry and selfish. In the distance, Noah's home glows with warm light, standing apart from the darkness. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

But all around Noah, the world had become a very bad place. People were mean and cruel. They fought with each other, stole, lied, and forgot all about God. It made God very sad to see the beautiful world He made filled with so much badness.

TIGRINYA:

Gn kulu bkewanin NoH, Alem bhwti Hfur qota tkone. Sebat Hfuran n gwdAtan neyrom. ytqAAtlu, yskrku, yHasw, n nAmlak ftstsum rsA'wom. Mrmr Alem zfTeRa bbluy Hfunet mskzmla Amlak bhwti Hzinu.

(Pronunciation: Hfur = bad, Hzinu = He was sad, gwdAtan = cruel)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Noah kneeling in prayer with golden divine light shining down on him from heaven. God's voice is represented by warm golden rays and gentle clouds parting. Noah looks up with a reverent, listening expression. His white hair glows in the divine light. The scene is intimate and holy. Simple landscape of his garden surrounds him. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

God spoke to Noah one day with an important message. "Noah, I am going to send a great flood to wash away all the badness in the world. But I will keep you and your family safe because you love and obey Me. I have a very special job for you."

TIGRINYA:

Amlak Hade meAlti nNoH Arzi Hbri neberwu. "NoH, nkulu Hfunet Alem kHtsa Abi mayi kleshl eyen. Gn nAkha n sdra betka kHALweKkum eyen kemey tfterwen n tteAzzewen sle ztkwn. Hade bflay srahArA kHbka eyen."

(Pronunciation: mayi = flood, kHALweKkum = I will keep you safe, srahArA = job)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration showing God's plan for the ark revealed to Noah. Noah stands looking amazed as golden light forms the shape of an enormous boat in the sky above him. The boat shape glows with divine light. Noah's eyes are wide with wonder. His sons stand behind him, also looking up in awe. The sky is golden and blue with clouds. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

"Build a big boat — an ark!" God told Noah. "Make it very, very large — bigger than anything anyone has ever built! Use strong wood and cover it with tar so no water can get in. I will tell you exactly how to build it." Noah listened carefully to every word.

TIGRINYA:

"Hade Abi jelba — merkeb shnet!" Amlak nNoH nebere. "Bhwiti Abi grA — kab zmkulu zebAelo zAbille! BrtA Entzti teQemisu n bzitin lekiyu may kemAyAtiw. BqTtu kndayday ktshno knberKa eyen." NoH nkulu qal btsmuq tsenitsyu.

(Pronunciation: jelba = boat, merkeb = ark, Entzti = wood, zitin = tar)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Noah and his three sons working hard building the ark. They saw wood, hammer nails, and carry large beams. The frame of the enormous boat rises behind them. Wood shavings cover the ground. Noah directs his sons with pointing hands. They are sweating but smiling. The ark is already taller than their house! Onlookers point and laugh in the background. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

Noah obeyed God right away! He and his sons began building the ark. They cut down tall trees, sawed wood into planks, and hammered day after day. People walking by laughed at Noah. "Why are you building a boat? There is no ocean here!" But Noah kept working.

TIGRINYA:

NoH bqTta nAmlak teAzize! Nsu n Awladu merkeb mshnat jemeru. Newtih Atsew qQitsitsiwom, Ab tsAbulat gezwom, meAlti db'Ar meAlti mesmeriwom. ZHalfu sebat nNoH seHaqu. "Slemntay jelba tshnE? Bahri Ab'zi yelen!" Gn NoH mshnat qetsele.

(Pronunciation: teAzize = he obeyed, mshnat = building, seHaqu = they laughed)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration showing the ark nearing completion — an enormous wooden boat sitting on dry land. It is incredibly large, towering over the houses nearby. Noah paints tar on the outside while his sons work on the deck. The boat has three levels visible through openings. Years have passed — Noah looks the same but the ark has grown massive. A single door is visible on the side. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

For many, many years, Noah and his family worked on the ark. It was so big — three floors high with rooms for every kind of animal! Finally, after all those years of hard work, the ark was finished. It was the biggest boat ever built! Now God had the next part of His plan.

TIGRINYA:

Nbluy bluy Amtat, NoH n sdra betu Ab merkeb serahyu. Bhwti Abi neyru — sleste degeretat bHat msl kdanat nkulu zryb Ensisa! Ab mewedsAta, dhri kulu'ta Amtat kbuD srahA, merkeb tewdAe. ZAbille Abi jelba neyru! Hzi Amlak nqtsli mdhani Hzyu.

(Pronunciation: Amtat = years, degeretat = floors, tewdAe = was finished)

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[PICTURE: A magical watercolor children's Bible illustration showing pairs of animals walking toward the ark from all directions. Two elephants, two giraffes, two lions, two butterflies, two rabbits — all walking peacefully together. They form lines leading to the ark's large door. Noah stands at the door welcoming them with open arms. Birds fly overhead in pairs. The scene is joyful and wondrous. East African/Eritrean features on Noah.]

ENGLISH:

Then an amazing thing happened! God sent animals from everywhere — two of every kind! Two elephants, two giraffes, two lions, two tiny mice, two colorful birds — all walking peacefully toward the ark! Noah did not have to go find them. God brought them all!

TIGRINYA:

Dhrzi Asdenemami nger tekewne! Amlak Ensisat kab kulu qota — klte kab kulu zryb — lesle! Klte Harbtat, klte zurafat, klte Anbsat, klte nnushtey Aynchat, klte Hburat Afrai — kulom bsllam nab merkeb ygAshshu! NoH kdsshom AydelIn. Amlak nkulom Amtsi'wom!

(Pronunciation: Ensisat = animals, klte = two, Harbtat = elephants)

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[PICTURE: A delightful watercolor children's Bible illustration showing the animals boarding the ark through the large door. Inside, we can peek and see different rooms — hay for the cows, perches for the birds, cozy spots for the cats. Noah's wife arranges food supplies. The sons guide animals gently to their places. There is a joyful, busy feeling — like moving day! All people have East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

Noah and his family guided all the animals onto the ark. Big animals went to the lower deck. Small animals and birds went to the upper floors. Noah's wife prepared food and water for everyone. What a busy and exciting time! The ark was filling up with life!

TIGRINYA:

NoH n sdra betu nkulu Ensisat nab merkeb Amrshiwom. Abi Ensisat nab tHtay dereja kedu. NnAshtsh Ensisat n Afrai nab IAAli dereja kedu. Bealti NoH meghbi n may nkulom Azewet. Kntfay tshkul n Asdenemami gzie! Merkeb bHywet ymla neyru!

(Pronunciation: Amrshiwom = guided them, dereja = deck, Hywet = life)

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[PICTURE: A solemn watercolor children's Bible illustration of the great door of the ark being closed by an invisible divine hand — golden light pushes the massive door shut. Noah and his family are safely inside, looking out a small window. Outside, the sky begins to darken with massive gray clouds. People who laughed before now look up at the sky with worry. The scene is dramatic and serious. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

When everyone was safely inside, God Himself closed the big door of the ark — BOOM! The door was shut tight. Noah's family was safe inside with all the animals. Outside, dark clouds began to fill the sky. The wind began to blow. Something big was about to happen.

TIGRINYA:

Kulom Ab wshti dwluw mskkonyu, Amlak btslotu nAbi Maetso merkeb — BUM! — zEge. Maetso tsAqiq tzEge. Sdra bet NoH msla kulu Ensisat Ab wshti dwluw neyrom. Ab deqe, tselelm Debnatat nsemay kemleA'wu. Nfas knfis jemere. Abi nger kmKwen neyru.

(Pronunciation: Maetso = door, dwluw = safe, Debnatat = clouds)

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[PICTURE: A dramatic watercolor children's Bible illustration of rain beginning to fall — huge drops splashing everywhere. Lightning flashes in dark purple-gray skies. The ark sits solidly on the ground as water begins to rise around it. Rain pours in thick sheets. Water flows from every direction. The scene is powerful but not terrifying — shown from inside the ark looking out a window where rain streams down. East African/Eritrean features on Noah's face visible at window.]

ENGLISH:

Then the rain began to fall! Not just a little rain — the biggest rainstorm ever! Water poured from the sky like rivers. It rained and rained and rained for forty days and forty nights! Water came up from the ground too. Everything was covered in water.

TIGRINYA:

Dhrzi znaB kznnb jemere! Hade nnush znaB qdra Ayknnon — zAbille Abi znaB! May kmsla ruba kab semay weridie. NArbaAte meAltitat n ArbaAte leytatat Aynqere! May kab mreAt dk'A wetse. Kulu nger bmay tekdeNe.

(Pronunciation: znaB = rain, ArbaAte = forty, may = water)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of the ark floating on an endless ocean of water. The ark bobs gently on massive waves. There is nothing but water in every direction — no land, no trees, nothing. The sky is gray with rain still falling. A small rainbow-colored bird (dove) sits on the ark's roof. Inside through a window, warm light glows — safety. The vast water shows God's power. East African/Eritrean features on Noah visible at window.]

ENGLISH:

The water rose higher and higher until even the tallest mountains were covered! The whole world was one big ocean. But the ark floated safely on top of the water, just like God promised. Inside, Noah's family and all the animals were warm, dry, and safe.

TIGRINYA:

May yelay n yelay kliE dk'A nzAbll newtih Adebarat kmKedN! MluE Alem Hade Abi bahri kone. Gn merkeb Ab IAAlI may dwluw yhAns neyru, kmsla Amlak ztsmE'A. Ab wshti, sdra bet NoH n kulu Ensisat wuuyat, nbshusat, n dwluwat neyrom.

(Pronunciation: Adebarat = mountains, bahri = ocean, yhAns = it floated)

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[PICTURE: A cozy watercolor children's Bible illustration of life inside the ark. Noah feeds the elephants hay. His wife milks a goat. A son sweeps the floor while birds chirp on rafters above. Cats curl up sleeping. A monkey plays with rope. Children (wives of the sons) pet a lamb. Oil lamps glow warmly. The scene is busy but peaceful and happy — a floating home. East African/Eritrean features on all people.]

ENGLISH:

Life inside the ark was busy! Every day, Noah and his family fed all the animals, gave them water, and cleaned their spaces. The cows mooed, the roosters crowed, and the monkeys played! It was like a floating farm. God took care of them all.

TIGRINYA:

Hywet Ab wshti merkeb tshkul neyre! Kulu meAlti, NoH n sdra betu nkulu Ensisat megibyom, may Hibyom, n qotAom Htsibywom. LAHmtat Hambauu, Derbawat tserHu, n Halgewyan tetsAwtu! KmsIa zhAns qrsHi neyre. Amlak nkulom tkebalkelywom.

(Pronunciation: megibyom = fed them, LAHmtat = cows, qrsHi = farm)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of the rain stopping and the first ray of sunlight breaking through the dark clouds. Noah looks out the ark's window with his family, their faces lit by the golden ray of sunshine. Hope fills their expressions. The water is still vast but calmer now. A patch of blue sky appears among the gray clouds. The moment feels like a new beginning. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

After many, many days, the rain finally stopped! Slowly, the water began to go down. The wind blew gently and the sun peeked through the clouds. Noah and his family were so happy to see sunlight again! But they still had to wait for the land to appear.

TIGRINYA:

Dhri bluy bluy mzEtat, znaB Ab mewedsAta dewe! bflflut, may kmttHt jemere. Nfas blHluH nefise tsHay kab DebnaAt tsmbilqiq belete. NoH n sdra betu tsHay dbritn kndz mskzrAyu bhwti teHagisu! Gn mreAt ktrAi gna kmtsnhyu neyrwom.

(Pronunciation: dewe = stopped, kmttHt = to go down, tsHay = sun)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Noah releasing a dove from the ark's window. The white dove flies gracefully against a clearing sky. Noah watches with hopeful eyes, one arm extended. His family gathers behind him looking up at the bird. The vast waters stretch below but mountaintops are beginning to peek above the surface in the distance. East African/Eritrean features on Noah and family.]

ENGLISH:

Noah sent out a dove to see if the land was dry yet. The first time, the dove came back because there was nowhere to land. Noah waited seven more days and sent the dove again. This time, the dove came back with a fresh green olive leaf in its beak! The land was drying!

TIGRINYA:

NoH Hanti rgbi Adu mreAt nbitsah entymkon ktrAi. Ab qedemta gize, rgbi temeles'a kemey zmAfrft qota sle zeybla. NoH shbuE mzEtat tsAnyu rgbi dbritn lesle'ya. HzA gize, rgbi bHdsh Imulimu qtsli zeytun Ab mHqara Hitza tmelset! MreAt tnqest neyra!

(Pronunciation: rgbi = dove, qtsli zeytun = olive leaf, tnqest = drying)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration showing the ark resting on top of a mountain (Mount Ararat) as the water recedes below. Green land is becoming visible — grass, trees beginning to sprout. The sky is bright blue and clear. Noah and his family wave excitedly from the deck. Animals peek their heads over the side, looking at the new land below. Joy fills the scene. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

Finally, after more than a year on the water, the ark came to rest on top of a tall mountain! The water kept going down, and green land appeared everywhere. Grass grew, flowers bloomed, and trees sprouted new leaves. The earth was clean and new and beautiful again!

TIGRINYA:

Ab mewedsAta, dhri kab Hade Amet Ab may, merkeb Ab IAAli newuH debri Atefire! May yelay n yelay kmttHt, Imulimu mreAt kulu qota tretse. sAri btQle, Abeba bHalqe, n Atsew Hdsth qtli Amtsiu. Mreaat ntsihA n Hdshti n mrmr dbritn kone!

(Pronunciation: debri = mountain, Atefire = rested, mreAt = land, Hdshti = new)

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[PICTURE: A joyous watercolor children's Bible illustration of the ark's door opening wide and animals streaming out in celebration! Elephants trumpet, birds burst into the sky in colorful flocks, rabbits hop down the mountainside, deer leap gracefully. Noah's family walks out with arms raised in joy and praise. Bright sunshine floods the scene. Green grass and wildflowers carpet the ground. East African/Eritrean features on all people.]

ENGLISH:

God told Noah, "Come out of the ark — you and your family and all the animals!" Noah opened the great door and everyone burst out with joy! The animals ran, flew, hopped, and galloped across the fresh new land. Noah's family took deep breaths of the clean, sweet air.

TIGRINYA:

Amlak nNoH "Kab merkeb wtsA — nsKa n sdra betKa n kulu Ensisat!" bele. NoH nAbi Maetso kfite kulom bHgos wetsu! Ensisat gweyeyu, bereru, zelewu, n gwedefu Ab Hdshti Imulimu mreAt. Sdra bet NoH bguHi ntsihA n mQmQam Ayr tsennfsu.

(Pronunciation: wtsA = come out, gweyeyu = they ran, bereru = they flew)

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[PICTURE: A reverent watercolor children's Bible illustration of Noah building a stone altar and praying with his family. They kneel together on the green mountainside with hands raised to heaven in gratitude. The altar has a small fire on it representing their offering to God. Golden divine light shines down on them. The empty ark sits in the background. Blue sky stretches overhead. East African/Eritrean features on all people.]

ENGLISH:

The first thing Noah did was thank God! He built an altar of stones and prayed with his family. "Thank You, God, for keeping us safe! Thank You for Your love and faithfulness!" God was pleased with Noah's grateful heart. Noah never forgot to say thank you.

TIGRINYA:

NoH bqedemta zgbero nAmlak mmsgan neyre! Nay Enwat mesewaEtya shenitu msla sdra betu tseleye. "Amlak, sle zmHALweKna neAmsgn! Nfqrkan n EmnetKa neAmsgn!" Amlak bAmsagani lbi NoH teHagiswu. NoH Amsganot ftstsum Aytrsue.

(Pronunciation: mesewaEtya = altar, Amsganot = thanksgiving, teHagiswu = was pleased)

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[PICTURE: A breathtakingly beautiful watercolor children's Bible illustration of a magnificent rainbow arching across the entire sky. Every color is vivid and bright — red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo, violet. Noah and his family stand below looking up in wonder, their faces lit by the rainbow's colors. The landscape is green and alive. Animals graze peacefully. The rainbow fills the whole sky like God's embrace. East African/Eritrean features.]

ENGLISH:

Then God painted the most beautiful rainbow across the sky! It stretched from one end of the earth to the other — glowing with every color. "This rainbow is My promise to you," God said. "I will never flood the whole earth again. Every time you see a rainbow, remember My love."

TIGRINYA:

Dhrzi Amlak nzAmqr mrmr qosti quzaH Ab semay Amlese! Kab Hade wetsAni mreAt nab kAllA — bkulu HbWi brHan. "ZA qosti quzaH tsmA'ye nAkha eyu," Amlak bele. "Nkulu mreAt dbritn Ab may ftstsum AyHtsin. Kulu gize qosti quzaH msktrAi, fqreye zeKr."

(Pronunciation: qosti quzaH = rainbow, tsmA'ye = my promise, fqreye = my love)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of Noah's family beginning a new life in the beautiful, fresh world. They plant a garden together, build a simple home, and play with animals. Children (grandchildren) run and laugh. The world is green and full of life. The rainbow is still faintly visible in the sky. Everything feels hopeful and new. A fresh start. East African/Eritrean features on all people.]

ENGLISH:

Noah and his family started a brand-new life in the beautiful clean world! They planted gardens, built homes, and filled the earth with love and goodness again. God blessed them and said, "Have many children and fill the earth!" It was like a brand-new beginning.

TIGRINYA:

NoH n sdra betu Ab mrmr ntsihA Alem Hdshti Hywet jemeru! Aradyo tekilu, gezatat shenitu, n mreAt bfqri n bTsbuQnet dbritn meleywo. Amlak meRiqom "Bluy Qolaat Hziqum mreAt mleywa!" bele. KmsIa Hade Hdshti mejemerya neyre.

(Pronunciation: Hdshti = new, Aradyo = gardens, meRiqom = blessed them)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of a modern scene — a child with East African/Eritrean features looking up at a beautiful rainbow in the sky after a rainstorm. The child stands in a green field, pointing up excitedly. Rain puddles reflect the rainbow. The child remembers Noah's story — a faint watercolor image of the ark appears in a thought bubble. Joy and wonder fill the child's face.]

ENGLISH:

To this very day, every time a rainbow appears in the sky after rain, it reminds us of God's promise to Noah! God always keeps His promises. He kept Noah safe, He saved the animals, and He gave the world a fresh start. Our God is faithful forever!

TIGRINYA:

Kab'ta meAlti, kulu gize qosti quzaH dhri znaB mskrtAi, ntsmAt Amlak nNoH yeZkrna! Amlak kulu gize tsmAtuu yHlw. NNoH Haliwu, nEnsisat AdHinuu, n nAlem Hdshti mejemerya Hibu. AmlakKna nZIAlem EmneNya eyu!

(Pronunciation: qosti quzaH = rainbow, tsmAtuu = His promises, EmneNya = faithful)

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[PICTURE: A warm watercolor children's Bible illustration of an East African/Eritrean child obeying their parent even when other children are going a different way. The child waves goodbye to friends who head toward something wrong, and walks toward home where a parent waits with open arms. A golden path of light shows the right way. The scene shows the courage of obedience like Noah had.]

ENGLISH:

Noah obeyed God even when everyone around him did the wrong thing. It was not easy! People laughed at him for years. But Noah kept doing what was right. You can be like Noah! Even when others choose wrong, you can choose to obey God and do what is right.

TIGRINYA:

NoH nAmlak teAzize dk'A kulom Ab kewaniNu Hfur mskgberu. QelAl AyKonen! Sebat nbluy Amtat seHaqwuu. Gn NoH TsbuQ kmgbat qetsele. KmsIa NoH ktkon tkhl! Kalot Hfur mskmrtsu dk'A, nsKa nAmlak kttAazezon TsbuQ ktgbern tmrits.

(Pronunciation: teAzize = he obeyed, TsbuQ = right/good, tmrits = choose)

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[PICTURE: A watercolor children's Bible illustration of an East African/Eritrean child patiently building a block tower over many days — shown in sequence panels. Day 1 shows the base, Day 2 shows it growing, Day 3 shows the finished tall tower. The child smiles proudly. Like Noah who worked for years, this child shows patience and faithfulness in finishing a task. Bright classroom setting.]

ENGLISH:

Noah worked on the ark for many years without giving up. He was patient and faithful even when he could not see the finish. God wants us to be patient too! When something takes a long time, do not give up. Keep going! Good things come to those who wait and trust God.

TIGRINYA:

NoH nbluy Amtat bkeyHdi Ab merkeb serahye. Btsmuwur n bEmnet neyre dk'A mewedsAta ktrAi mskAydekelet. Amlak nHna'wn tsmuwan knnkwn ydly! Hade nger newuH gize mskwsede, AytHdi. Qtsul! TsbuQ ngeratat nzytsnhyu n nAmlak zmAmnu ymetse.

(Pronunciation: tsmuwan = patient, AytHdi = don't give up, Qtsul = keep going)

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[PICTURE: A serene watercolor children's Bible illustration of an East African/Eritrean child standing in rain under an umbrella, looking up and smiling. Instead of being scared of the storm, the child trusts that it will pass. In the sky, a faint rainbow begins to form behind the dark clouds — God's promise visible even in hard times. Puddles reflect colors. The child is peaceful and trusting.]

ENGLISH:

Sometimes life feels like a big storm — scary and dark. But just like God kept Noah safe through the flood, God will keep you safe through hard times too. After every storm comes a rainbow! Trust that God is with you, even in the hardest moments. Better days are coming!

TIGRINYA:

HndHnd gize Hywet kmsla Abi Hbri — Asfrahi n tslelm — ymsselna. Gn kmsla Amlak nNoH Ab may AdHinuu, Amlak nAkha'wn Ab kbudat gzeyat yHAlweKha. Dhri kulu Hbri qosti quzaH ymetse! Amlak dk'A Ab zkbudu gzie mssAlkha mKanu AmniKa. ZysBl meAlttat ymetse!

(Pronunciation: Hbri = storm, qosti quzaH = rainbow, AmniKa = trust)

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[PICTURE: A colorful watercolor children's Bible illustration of East African/Eritrean children and animals together in a sunny garden. The children gently pet and care for various animals — a child hugs a lamb, another feeds a bird, another brushes a pony. A rainbow arcs across the sky above. The scene shows love for God's creation. Flowers bloom everywhere. Joy radiates from every face.]

ENGLISH:

Let us pray together! Dear God, thank You for the story of Noah and the rainbow. Thank You that You always keep Your promises. Help us to obey You like Noah did, even when it is hard. Help us to be patient and trust You. Thank You for Your beautiful world and all the animals. We love You! Amen.

TIGRINYA:

Bhmakha ntseluy! Fqur Amlak, nzAntA NoH n qosti quzaH neAmsgn. Kulu gize tsmAtKa sle ztHlw neAmsgn. KmsIa NoH kntAazzeKa HarAina, dk'A kyblx entymkonu. Tsmuwan knnkwn n kmntAmneKha HarAina. NmrmrAlemKa n nkulu Ensisat neAmsgn. NfteweKha ina! Amen.

(Pronunciation: ntseluy = let us pray, tsmAtKa = Your promises, NfteweKha = we love You)

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[PICTURE: A radiant watercolor children's Bible illustration of a single East African/Eritrean child standing outdoors with arms stretched wide, face turned up to a sky filled with a magnificent rainbow. The child wears modern clothes and has the biggest smile of wonder and joy. Golden light surrounds the child. Below, colorful animals peek from behind flowers and bushes. The image radiates God's faithfulness, promise, and love.]

ENGLISH:

Always remember: God ALWAYS keeps His promises! Just like He promised Noah with the rainbow, God promises to love you, protect you, and never leave you. Every rainbow you see is God saying "I love you!" You are safe in God's hands. His love for you will never, ever end!

TIGRINYA:

Kulu gize zeKr: Amlak KULU GIZE tsmAtuu yHlw! KmsIa nNoH bqosti quzaH ztsmE'A, Amlak kfterKa, kHAlweKa, n ftstsum kmHadgeKa ytsmE. Kulu qosti quzaH ztrAi Amlak "EfteweKha!" ymbI zlo eyu! Ab Adi Amlak dwluw ukha. Fqru nAkha ftstsum ftstsum AytuwdAn!

(Pronunciation: tsmAtuu = His promises, yHlw = He keeps, kfterKa = to love you)

The Moral

tmhrti

ENGLISH: God always keeps His promises and rewards those who faithfully obey Him. Like Noah, we should do what is right even when others choose wrong. God is faithful through every storm in our lives, and His love never ends. The rainbow reminds us that after hard times, God brings new beginnings and beautiful blessings.

TIGRINYA: Amlak kulu gize tsmAtuu yHlw n bEmnet nztteAazezu yKHs. KmsIa NoH, Kalot Hfur mskmrtsu dk'A TsbuQ kmgbar Alena. Amlak Ab kulu Hbri Hywetna EmneNya eyu, fqrū dk'A ftstsum AytuwdAn. Qosti quzaH dhri kbudat gzeyat, Amlak Hdsht mjemertat n mrmr meRiqotat kAmtse yeZkrna.

Bible Verse

tqsi metsHaf qddus

ENGLISH: "I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth."

— Genesis 9:13

TIGRINYA: "Qosti quzaHeye Ab Debnatat Aqimeywa, nHa dk'A mAlAmA kidan ab maEkeleye n mreAt ktkwn eya."

— Beresi 9:13

Talk About It

bzaEba'zi tezarebu

1. ENGLISH: Why did God ask Noah to build the ark? What made Noah special?

TIGRINYA: Amlak nNoH merkeb kshni slemntay Hatetwu? Mntay eyu nNoH bflay zgbero?

2. ENGLISH: How do you think Noah felt when people laughed at him? Have you ever been laughed at for doing the right thing?

TIGRINYA: Sebat mskseHaqwu NoH kndayday kemzi giru tblw tHsbu? TsbuQ nger bsbe mgbarKha sebat seHaquka yfITu?

3. ENGLISH: What does the rainbow remind us of? What promises has God made to you?

TIGRINYA: Qosti quzaH mntay eyu zyezakrna? Amlak nAkha mntay tsmAtat eyu zgtseyelka?

4. ENGLISH: What is your favorite animal that was on Noah's ark? Why?

TIGRINYA: Ab merkeb NoH ztfterya Ensisa meN eyu? Slemntay?

Prayer

tseLOT

ENGLISH: Dear God, thank You for always keeping Your promises. Thank You for the beautiful rainbow that reminds us of Your faithful love. Help me to obey You like Noah did, even when others do not. Help me to be patient and trust You when things are hard. Thank You for protecting me through every storm. I know You will never leave me. In Jesus' name, Amen.

TIGRINYA: Fqur Amlak, kulu gize tsmAtKa sle ztHlw neAmsgn. Mrmr qosti quzaH EmneNya fqrKa zyzakrna neAmsgn. KmsIa NoH kntAazzeKa HarAini dk'A Kalot mskAygbru. Ngeratat mskykbdu tsmuwan kkon n kmtAmneKha HarAini. Ab kulu Hbri sle ztHAlweni neAmsgn. Ftstsum kkHdgeni kemzAytwn eflT. BsMe IyeSus, Amen.

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